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Sunday Worship
8:30 & 11:00 AM

Living Savior Lutheran Church and Preschool

December 14, 2025

The Third Sunday of Advent

11:00 AM



THIRD SUNDAY OF
ADVENT

www.livingsaviorlutheran.org

The Third Sunday of Advent
December 14, 2025
11:00 A.M.

Welcome to worship! On this Third Sunday in Advent, we are reminded of the words of the old spiritual, "Go and tell John." Whenever we have moments where we may have a question about what the Lord is doing in our life, we can be encouraged with the words that Jesus spoke, "Go and tell John what you have seen and heard . . . the blind see, the lame walk . . ." O come, O come, Emmanuel!

Prelude

"Hark the Glad Sound"

Michael Burkhardt

Welcome

Please stand

Entrance Hymn

"Let the Earth Now Praise the Lord" #352



1 Let the earth now praise the Lord, Who has tru - ly
2 What the Fa - thers most de - sired, What the proph - ets'
3 A - bram's prom - ised great re - ward, Zi - on's help - er,
4 As Your com - ing was in peace, Qui - et, full of



kept His word And at last to us did send
heart in - spired, What they longed for man - y a year,
Ja - cob's Lord— Him of two - fold race be - hold—
gen - tle - ness, Let the same mind dwell in me



Christ, the sin - ner's help and friend.
Stands ful - filled in glo - ry here.
Tru - ly came, as long fore - told.
Which is Yours e - ter - nal - ly.

- 5 Bruise for me the serpent's head
That, set free from doubt and dread,
I may cling to You in faith,
Safely kept through life and death.
- 6 Then when You will come again
As the glorious king to reign,
I with joy will see Your face,
Freely ransomed by Your grace.

Text: Heinrich Held, 1620–59; tr. Catherine Winkworth, 1827–78, alt.
Tune: Geistliche gesangk Buchleyn, 1524, Wittenberg, ed. Johann Walter
Text and tune: Public domain

Invocation

The sign of the cross may be made by all in remembrance of their Baptism.

[P] In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit.

[C] Amen.

Confession and Forgiveness

[P] If we say we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us.

[C] But if we confess our sins, God, who is faithful and just, will forgive our sins and cleanse us from all unrighteousness.

(Silence for reflection on God's Word and for self-examination.)

[P] Let us then confess our sins to God our Father.

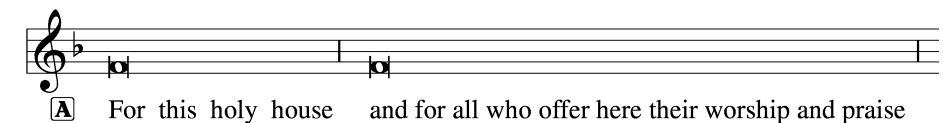
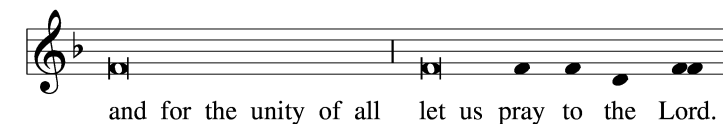
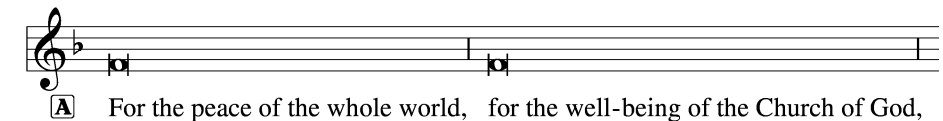
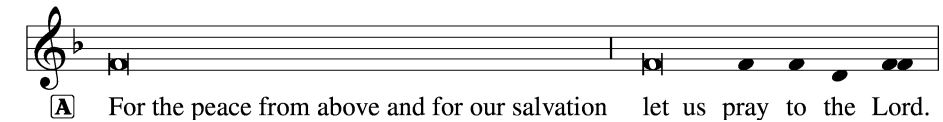
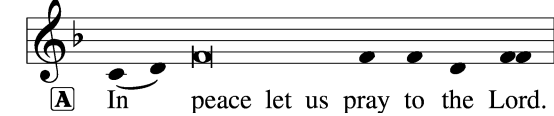
[C] Most merciful God, we confess that we are by nature sinful and unclean. We have sinned against You in thought, word, and deed, by what we have done and by what we have left undone. We have not loved You with our whole heart; we have not loved our neighbors as ourselves. We justly deserve Your present and eternal punishment. For the sake of Your Son, Jesus Christ, have mercy on us. Forgive us, renew us, and lead us, so that we may delight in Your will and walk in Your ways to the glory of Your holy name. Amen.

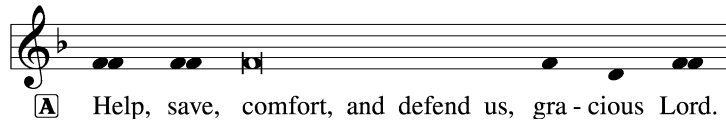
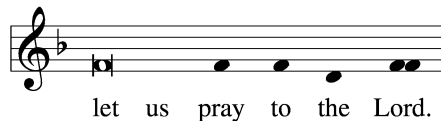
[P] Upon this your confession, I, by virtue of my office, as a called and ordained servant of the Word, announce the grace of God unto all of you, and in the stead and by the command of my Lord Jesus Christ I

forgive you all your sins in the name of the Father and of the Son ✠ and of the Holy Spirit.

[C] Amen.

Kyrie





The Salutation and the Prayer of the Day

P The Lord be with you.

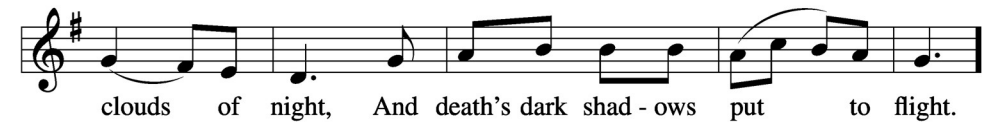
C And also with you.

P Let us pray: Lord Jesus Christ, we implore You to hear our prayers and to lighten the darkness of our hearts by Your gracious visitation; for You live and reign with the Father and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever.

C Amen.

The Lighting of the Advent Wreath

C We light this candle as a symbol of JOY. May the joyful promise of your presence, O God, make us rejoice in our hope of salvation. O Come, O Come, Emmanuel.



Text: Latin, c. 12th cent.; Psalterium Canticum Catholicarum, 1710, Köln; tr. John Mason Neale, 1818-66, alt.
Tune: French, 15th cent.
Text and tune: Public domain

Please be seated

THE SCRIPTURE READINGS

First Lesson

Isaiah 35:1-10

¹The wilderness and the dry land shall be glad; the desert shall rejoice and blossom like the crocus; ²it shall blossom abundantly and rejoice with joy and singing. The glory of Lebanon shall be given to it, the majesty of Carmel and Sharon. They shall see the glory of the LORD, the majesty of our God. ³Strengthen the weak hands, and make firm the feeble knees. ⁴Say to those who have an anxious heart, "Be strong; fear not! Behold, your God will come with vengeance, with the recompense of God. He will come and save you." ⁵Then the eyes of the blind shall be opened, and the ears of the deaf unstopped; ⁶then shall the lame man leap like a deer, and the tongue of the mute sing for joy. For waters break forth in the wilderness, and streams in the desert; ⁷the burning sand shall become a pool, and the thirsty ground springs of water; in the haunt of jackals, where they lie down, the grass shall become reeds and rushes. ⁸And a highway shall be there, and it shall be called the Way of Holiness; the unclean shall not pass over it. It shall belong to those who walk on the way; even if they are fools, they shall not go astray. ⁹No lion shall be there, nor shall any ravenous beast come up on it; they shall not be found there, but the redeemed shall walk there. ¹⁰And the ransomed of the LORD shall return and come to Zion with singing; everlasting joy shall be upon their

heads; they shall obtain gladness and joy, and sorrow and sighing shall flee away.

- [L] This is the Word of the Lord.
- [C] Thanks be to God.

Gradual Hymn “Come, Thou Long-Expected Jesus” #338

1 Come, Thou long - ex - pect-ed Je-sus, Born to set Thy peo-ple free;
2 Born Thy peo-ple to de - liv-er; Born a child and yet a king!

From our fears and sins re-lease us; Let us find our rest in Thee.
Born to reign in us for-ev - er, Now Thy gra - cious king-dom bring.

Is - rael's strength and con-so - la-tion, Hope of all the earth Thou art,
By Thine own e - ter-nal Spir-it Rule in all our hearts a - lone;

Dear de - sire of ev-'ry na-tion, Joy of ev - 'ry long-ing heart.
By Thine all - suf - fi - cient mer - it Raise us to Thy glo-rious throne.

Text: Charles Wesley, 1707-88, alt.
Tune: Southern Harmony, 1835, New Haven
Text and tune: Public domain

Second Lesson James 5:7-11

⁷Be patient, therefore, brothers, until the coming of the Lord. See how the farmer waits for the precious fruit of the earth, being patient about it, until it receives the early and the late rains. ⁸You also, be patient. Establish your hearts, for the coming of the Lord is at hand. ⁹Do not grumble against one another, brothers, so that you may not be judged; behold, the Judge is standing at the door. ¹⁰As an example of suffering and patience, brothers, take the prophets who spoke in the name of the Lord.

¹¹Behold, we consider those blessed who remained steadfast. You have heard of the steadfastness of Job, and you have seen the purpose of the Lord, how the Lord is compassionate and merciful.

- [L] This is the Word of the Lord.
- [C] Thanks be to God.

Please stand

The Verse

The Third Sunday of Advent

Matthew 11:10 (ESV) Wallace Horton

Liltingly

Al - le - lu - ia. Al - le - lu - ia. Al - le - lu - ia. Al - le - lu - ia.

Be - hold, I send my mess - en - ger be - fore your — face,

who will pre - pare your way be - fore — you.

Al - le - lu - ia. Al - le - lu - ia. Al - le - lu - ia. Al - le - lu - ia.

- [P] The Holy Gospel is written...
- [C] Glo - ry to You, O Lord.

Holy Gospel Matthew 11:2-15

²When John heard in prison about the deeds of the Christ, he sent word by his disciples ³and said to him, “Are you the one who is to come, or shall we look for another?” ⁴And Jesus answered them, “Go and tell John what you hear and see: ⁵the blind receive their sight and the lame walk, lepers

are cleansed and the deaf hear, and the dead are raised up, and the poor have good news preached to them. ⁶And blessed is the one who is not offended by me.”

⁷As they went away, Jesus began to speak to the crowds concerning John: “What did you go out into the wilderness to see? A reed shaken by the wind? ⁸What then did you go out to see? A man dressed in soft clothing? Behold, those who wear soft clothing are in kings’ houses. ⁹What then did you go out to see? A prophet? Yes, I tell you, and more than a prophet. ¹⁰This is he of whom it is written,

“Behold, I send my messenger before your face,
who will prepare your way before you.’

¹¹Truly, I say to you, among those born of women there has arisen no one greater than John the Baptist. Yet the one who is least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he. ¹²From the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of heaven has suffered violence, and the violent take it by force. ¹³For all the Prophets and the Law prophesied until John, ¹⁴and if you are willing to accept it, he is Elijah who is to come. ¹⁵He who has ears to hear, let him hear.”

P This is the Gospel of the Lord.



C Praise to You, O Christ.

Please be seated
(Welcome Books Distributed)

The Children’s Lesson

Please stand
Hymn of the Day **“Hark the Glad Sound” #349**



1 Hark the glad sound! The Sav - ior comes, The Sav - ior
2 He comes the pris - 'ners to re - lease, In Sa - tan's
3 He comes the bro - ken heart to bind, The bleed - ing
4 Our glad ho - san - nas, Prince of Peace, Thy wel - come



prom - ised long; Let ev - 'ry heart pre - pare a
bond - age held. The gates of brass be - fore Him
soul to cure, And with the trea - sures of His
shall pro - claim, And heav'n's e - ter - nal arch - es



throne And ev - 'ry voice a song.
burst, The i - ron fet - ters yield.
grace To en - rich the hum - ble poor.
ring With Thy be - lov - ed name.

Text: Philip Doddridge, 1702–51
Tune: Thomas Haweis, 1734–1820
Text and tune: Public domain

Please be seated
Sermon **Pastor Gary Rueter**

Please stand
Nicene Creed

We believe in one God, the Father Almighty, maker of heaven and earth and of all things visible and invisible.

And in one Lord Jesus Christ, the only begotten Son of God, begotten of his Father before all worlds, God of God, Light of light, very God of very God, begotten, not made, being of one substance with the Father by whom all things were made; who for us and for our salvation came down from heaven and was incarnate by the Holy Spirit of the Virgin Mary and was made man; and was crucified also for us under Pontius Pilate. He suffered and was buried. The third day he rose again according to the Scriptures and ascended into heaven and sits at the right hand of the Father. And he

will come again with glory to judge both the living and the dead, whose kingdom will have no end.

And we believe in the Holy Spirit, the Lord and giver of life, who proceeds from the Father and the Son, who with the Father and the Son together is worshiped and glorified, who spoke by the prophets. And we believe in one holy catholic and apostolic Church, we acknowledge one Baptism for the remission of sins, and we look for the resurrection of the dead and the life of the world to come. Amen.

The Prayers of the Church
(Congregation responds: “Hear our Prayer” after each intercession)

The Lord’s Prayer

Please be seated
Tithes and Offerings Received
(Whether you give your tithes and offerings in-person or electronically, it is during this Act of Worship when we are mindful of everything that God gives to us).

Offering Music “Hark the Glad Sound” Wilbur Held

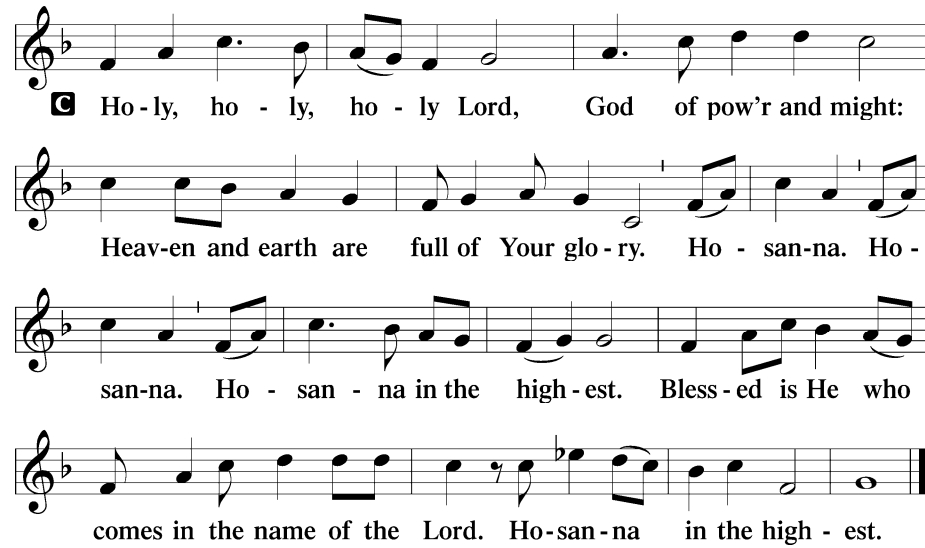
Please stand
The Offertory **“Let the Vineyards Be Fruitful”**

Let the vine - yards be fruit-ful, Lord, And fill to the brim our
cup of bless-ing. Gath - er a har-vest from the seeds that were
sown, That we may be fed with the bread of life. Gath - er the
hopes and the dreams of all; U - nite them with the prayers we

of - fer now. Grace our ta - ble with Your pres - ence, and
give us A fore-taste of the feast to come.

Order of Holy Communion
Preface

P The Lord be with you.
C And al - so with you.
P Lift up your hearts.
C We lift them to the Lord.
P Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.
C It is right to give Him thanks and praise.
P It is truly good, right, and salutary . . . evermore praising You and singing:

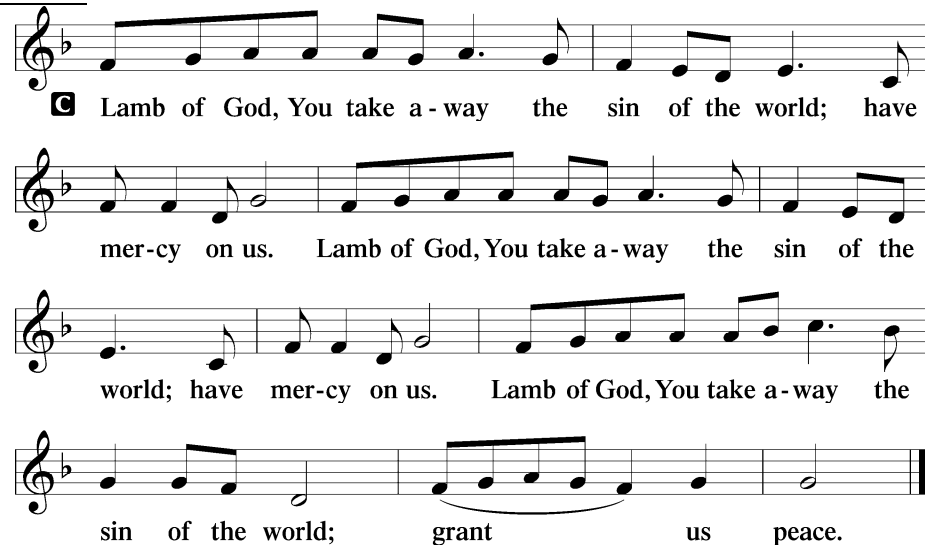


C Ho-ly, ho - ly, ho - ly Lord, God of pow'r and might:
 Heav-en and earth are full of Your glo - ry. Ho - san-na. Ho -
 san-na. Ho - san - na in the high - est. Bless - ed is He who
 comes in the name of the Lord. Ho-san-na in the high - est.

✠ The Words of Institution

P The peace of the Lord be with you always.
C And also with you.

Agnus Dei



C Lamb of God, You take a - way the sin of the world; have
 mer-cy on us. Lamb of God, You take a - way the sin of the
 world; have mer-cy on us. Lamb of God, You take a - way the
 sin of the world; grant us peace.

Please be seated

The Distribution

Communion Hymn

“Your Table I Approach” #628



1 Your ta - ble I ap - proach; Dear Sav - ior, hear my prayer.
 2 Lord, I con - fess my sins And mourn their wretch - ed bands;
 3 Your bod - y and Your blood, Once slain and shed for me,
 4 Search not how this takes place, This won - drous mys - ter - y;
 Let not an un - re - pen - tant heart Prove hurt - ful to me there.
 A con - trite heart is sure to find For - give - ness at Your hands.
 Are tak - en at Your ta - ble, Lord, In blest re - al - i - ty.
 God can ac - com - plish vast - ly more Than what we think could be.

- 5 O grant, most blessed Lord,
 That earth and hell combined
 May not about this sacrament
 Raise doubt within my mind.
- 6 Oh, may I never fail
 To thank You day and night
 For Your true body and true blood,
 O God, my peace and light.

Text: Gerhard Wolter Molanus, 1633–1722; tr. Matthias Loy, 1828–1915, alt.
 Tune: Trente quatre Pseaumes de David, 1551, Geneva, ed. Louis Bourgeois
 Text and tune: Public domain

Please stand

Post-Communion Canticle

Alleluia, He is Coming

Musical notation for the Post-Communion Canticle. The melody is in G major (one sharp) and 4/4 time. The lyrics are:

1. I looked up and I saw my Lord a - com - ing, — I looked
2. I looked up and I saw my Lord a - weep-ing, — I looked
3. I looked up and I saw my Lord a - dy - ing, — I looked
4. I looked up and I saw my Lord a - ris - ing, — I looked

up and I saw my Lord a - com - ing down the road. —
up and I saw my Lord a - weep-ing for my sins. —
up and I saw my Lord a - dy - ing on the cross. —
up and I saw my Lord a - ris - ing from the grave. —

Refrain

Al - le - lu - ia, He is com-ing, — Al - le - lu - ia, He is
here. — Al - le - lu - ia, He is coming, —
Al - le - lu - ia, He is here. —

CCLI Song #34642
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The Benediction

P The Lord bless you and keep you; The Lord make His face shine upon you and be gracious to you; The Lord look upon you with favor, and give you peace.

Musical notation for the Benediction. The melody is in G major (one sharp) and 4/4 time. The lyrics are:

A - men.

Dismissal Hymn

“Soon and Very Soon”

Musical notation for the Dismissal Hymn. The melody is in G major (one sharp) and 4/4 time. The lyrics are:

1. Soon and ver - y soon, we are going to see the King;
2. No more cry - ing there, we are going to see the King;
3. No more dy - ing there, we are going to see the King;
4. Soon and ver - y soon, we are going to see the King;

soon and ver - y soon, we are going to see the King;
no more cry - ing there, we are going to see the King;
no more dy - ing there, we are going to see the King;
soon and ver - y soon, we are going to see the King;

soon and ver - y soon, we are going to see the King; Hal-le-
no more cry - ing there, we are going to see the King;
no more dy - ing there, we are going to see the King;
soon and ver - y soon, we are going to see the King;

1, 2, 3.
lu - jah! Hal-le - lu - jah! We're going to see the King.

4.
going to see the King! Hal - le - lu - jah! Hal - le - lu -

jah! Hal - le - lu - jah! Hal - le - lu - jah!

WORDS and MUSIC: Andraé Crouch

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Greetings and Announcements

Postlude “Come, Thou Long Expected Jesus” Wilbur Held